

A REPORT ON

An “Unpaid”, Paid Internship

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Designation Department:
Programs Team

NGO's Name:
CRY (Child Rights and You), New Delhi

Partner NGO:
Nav Srishti, New Delhi

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I am deeply grateful to CRY: Child Rights and You, for providing me with the opportunity to undertake this internship and for allowing me to engage meaningfully with one of its long-standing partner organisations, Nav Srishti.

I would like to sincerely thank Mrs. Savita, my supervisor, for her steady guidance and clarity throughout the course of this internship. Her feedback helped me stay anchored in the work and shaped how I approached each task with both thought and purpose.

My heartfelt thanks to Mrs. Reena Banerjee, Secretary of Nav Srishti, whose openness, warmth, and trust allowed me to understand the institutional challenges from a closer perspective. Her deep commitment to the communities she serves was a quiet but powerful lesson throughout my time there.

I also extend special thanks to Uma Ma'am, whose work with students, despite limited resources and overwhelming responsibilities, was both humbling and inspiring. Her dedication reminded me that **impact is often forged not through grand actions, but through quiet persistence**. Observing her navigate resource constraints with determination was one of the most valuable parts of my internship experience.

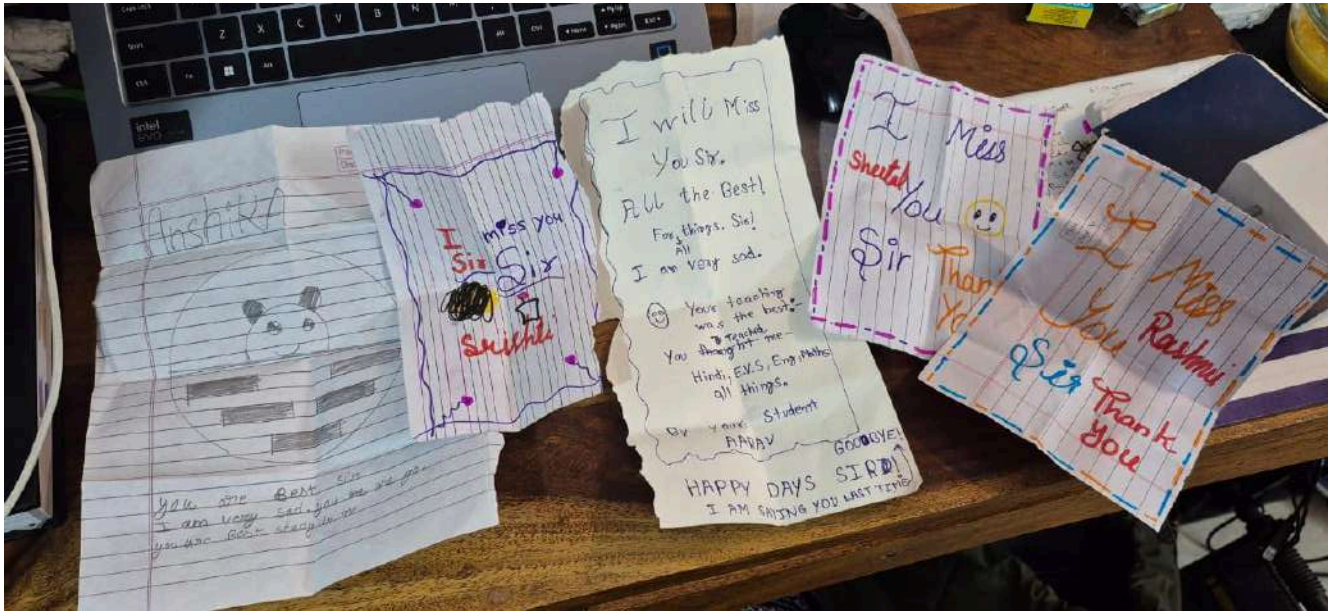
To the entire team at Nav Srishti, my fellow interns, and every student who allowed me to be a small part of their everyday learning, I am truly thankful. This experience has left a lasting impression, and I carry forward much more than I could have expected.



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I joined CRY with a blank slate. It was a decision made during a difficult period in my life. It ended up healing me in ways that most wouldn't imagine, and I learned so many things I never expected to. Here's what the "payment" part of the title suggests:



Introduction:

I joined CRY with no expectations of what the organisation would provide. On the very first day, due to a miscommunication in the allotment email, I arrived at 8:00 AM, earlier than expected by staff. Since the allotment mail mentioned no timings, I arrived at the branch's opening hour by default. I met the other two interns, my colleagues for the month, around 10:00 AM. We were debriefed and sent to Nav Srishti.

Nav Srishti is an NGO funded by CRY in Nagloi, Saket, South Delhi. According to Mrs. Reena Banerjee (Secretary, Nav Srishti), it was the first NGO in the region to receive a grant from CRY in 1994.

Nav Srishti, supported by CRY, operates primarily to serve the marginalized Banjaara basti and Gosai communities in the region, and although we weren't assigned specific tasks to achieve there, I'd like to think that I approached it as an adolescent craving for achievement.

Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive account of a four-week social internship undertaken with CRY: Child Rights and You, through its regional partner, Nav Srishti, located in the Nagloi, Saket area of South Delhi. CRY, a national child rights organisation founded in 1979, is widely regarded for its rights-based approach to child development. Its Delhi regional office plays a pivotal role in coordinating interventions across northern India, partnering with over 30 grassroots NGOs to address issues related to education, healthcare, protection, and child participation.

Nav Srishti, the host NGO for this internship, works primarily with children from the marginalised Banjaara basti and Gosai communities. The organisation provides informal education, vocational training, and child protection interventions within a low-resource urban setting. The internship was designed to offer field-level exposure to the systemic and operational challenges faced by such organisations, with a focus on education delivery, institutional management, and social welfare infrastructure.

Over the course of the internship, responsibilities spanned three core domains:

1. **Classroom Instruction:**

Teaching responsibilities were carried out through H.E.M.S. (Hindi, English, Mathematics, Science) classes for children aged 7 to 12, following a structured weekly timetable. Lessons were adapted to suit varying literacy levels and supported by worksheets. For students aged 12 to 18, topic-based sessions in human biology were conducted using visual aids, Canva presentations, and analogy-based methods to ensure conceptual clarity.

2. **Institutional Systems Support:**

Contributions included the drafting of an intern code of conduct, planning a structured handover system for future intern cycles, and organising over three decades of institutional reports and case studies. Additionally, a cross-branch Excel-based coordination sheet was developed to reflect status updates from other Nav Srishti centres.

3. **Program Development and Research:**

Initiatives such as the “Green Corner” environmental education program and a career counselling seminar for older students were designed and executed. Parallely, secondary research using NFHS-3, 4, and 5 data was carried out to develop thematic reports on maternal health, malnutrition, girls' education, and child protection. This data was used to compare national trends against field-level realities observed during the internship.

Throughout the internship, several critical institutional gaps became evident. These included acute staff shortages, where a single teacher was tasked with educating over 90 students daily,

lack of subject-specific instruction, infrastructural decay, and the complete absence of libraries, printed study material, or basic hygiene provisions. Technological limitations further restricted educational delivery, and certain streams, particularly the Arts, were entirely excluded from the curriculum.

Despite these structural constraints, the internship offered a rare and unfiltered view into the operations of a grassroots-level NGO. It illuminated the pressures faced by frontline educators, the disconnect between top-level planning and on-ground execution, and the ways in which community resilience sustains these systems in the absence of adequate institutional support.

Key recommendations include hiring specialised subject teachers, investing in basic infrastructure (ventilation, water access, sanitation), formalising intern processes, and re-integrating marginalised academic streams. Programmatically, further emphasis should be placed on health and psychosocial interventions, particularly for adolescents.

While the internship was limited by time, scope, and authority, it provided valuable insight into the mechanics of NGO operations and the lived realities of underserved communities. More than anything, it underscored that social change work is neither immediate nor glamorous, it is sustained, often invisible, and always urgent.

CRY: Child Rights and You, Delhi:

A beacon for child-rights advocacy since 1979, CRY: Child Rights and You (CRY) operates its North regional headquarters from Said-ul-Ajaib, New Delhi. Over four decades, the organisation has transformed the lives of 4.7 million Indian children, ensuring they survive, learn, are protected, and participate in decisions affecting them. CRY-Delhi sustains this nationwide legacy through a robust blend of grassroots partnerships, policy advocacy, volunteer mobilisation, and high visibility public campaigns.

My point of interest for this social internship program with CRY was multifaceted, covering topics like education, healthcare, and management problems and systems in grassroots level NGO's, along with structural and managerial issues between top level management and lowest level management.

1.0 Introduction

CRY is India's most trusted child-rights NGO, recognised for pioneering a rights-based rather than welfare-based approach. The Delhi regional office coordinates interventions across the northern belt, partners with 30-plus local NGOs, and serves as a strategic advocacy hub influencing both state and Union-level policy.

1.1 About the NGO

Parameter	Details
Legal status	Registered society under Societies Registration Act 1860
Year founded	1979 by Air India purser Rippan Kapur with six friends
Headquarters	Mumbai; regional offices in Delhi, Bengaluru, Kolkata, Chennai
Delhi address	632, Lane No.3, Westend Marg, Near Saket Metro, Said-ul-Ajaib, New Delhi 110030
Children impacted (pan-India)	4.7 million+ across 20 states
Delhi regional footprint	45 district blocks in Delhi-NCR, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan



1.2 Vision

“A happy, healthy and creative child whose rights are protected and honoured in a society built on respect for dignity, justice and equity for all”.

1.3 Mission

CRY articulates its mission in three pillars:

- Taking Responsibility: enable citizens to confront child-rights violations.
- Mobilising Potential: help people discover their capacity for action.
- Inspiring Collective Action: forge alliances to secure children's rights.

1.4 Core Values

After my interview, the employees cite CRY's foundational values of dedication, integrity and accountability. These are operationalised through:

- Transparent financial disclosures and audited statements.
- Volunteer action groups that self-govern and publicly critique CRY's own projects, reflecting a culture of constructive accountability.
- Zero-tolerance for misconduct via ethics hotlines and annual integrity trainings mirroring global best practice.

1.5 Organisational Culture

1.5.1 Volunteer-Centric Ethos

CRY-Delhi hosts India's largest urban volunteer cohort for child rights, comprising university collectives (e.g., SRCC chapter) and community Public Action Groups. Volunteers design campaigns, conduct photojournalism drives, and even stall municipal demolitions of underperforming schools.

1.5.2 Participatory Decision Making

Grassroots partners co-create annual project plans; beneficiary children attend quarterly "Bal Sabhas," presenting report cards on CRY's own performance.

1.6 Scope of Work

Rights Cluster	Key Delhi -NCR Interventions	2024–25 Outcomes
Survival (health & nutrition)	Nutritional rehabilitation camps, adolescent anemia drives, revival of Delhi sanitary-pad scheme via RTI	92% children <5 in project areas free from under-nutrition
Development (education)	Learning centres, School Management Committee training, #SchoolTheSpark cycling awareness ride flagged off from Delhi Cantt	94% children 6-18 in CRY areas enrolled in school
Protection	RTI-based audits of child-labour hotspots (Sadar Bazar, Seelampur e-waste hub); community vigilance committees	88% children 6-18 safeguarded from labour

Participation	“Bal Panchayat” simulations in North-West Delhi slums; photography workshops empowering children to narrate lived realities	99% adolescent girls in project areas protected from child marriage
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2. Governance and Accountability Mechanisms

2.1 Board Composition and Regional Leadership

The Delhi office is steered by a Regional Director (North) reporting to the national CEO. Advisory committees include volunteer representatives, corporate donors, and child delegates.

2.2 Financial Stewardship

GuideStar India’s Platinum Seal and Trust Research Advisory’s “Most Trusted NGO” rankings validate CRY’s fiscal probity. Delhi-specific projects publicly disclose cost-per-beneficiary ratios; a sanitary-pad scheme revival delivered 134× social return on investment.

3. Strategic Partnerships

- **Government:** MoWCD task-forces on child marriage; Delhi Commission for Protection of Child Rights joint inspections.
- **Academia:** Research MoUs with Ambedkar University and Delhi School of Social Work for child-labour baseline studies.
- **Corporate:** CSR alliances with DLF, Microsoft, Tata AIA, Oracle fund Delhi learning centres.
- **Media & Creative Agencies:** BBH India crafted CRY’s animated PSA; Nazara Foundation supports photo drives.

4. Impact Measurement Framework

CRY deploys a four-tier monitoring system:

1. **Child-level:** health check-ups, learning assessments.
2. **Household-level:** income tracking, school retention.
3. **Community-level:** functioning of Anganwadis, schools, child-protection committees.
4. **Policy-level:** RTI responses, budget allocations, legislative amendments.

Annual third-party evaluations validate outcome metrics, ensuring alignment with Sustainable Development Goals 2, 3, 4, 5, 8 and 16.

5. Conclusion

CRY-Delhi embodies a rare synergy of grassroots action, volunteer passion and evidence-based advocacy. Anchored in its vision of a joyous childhood for every Indian child, the organisation's integrity-driven culture and expansive programmatic scope make it an indispensable stakeholder in the capital's quest for inclusive development. By continually mobilising citizens, influencing policy and empowering children themselves, CRY ensures that child rights remain central to Delhi's social agenda.

Appendix: Quick-Reference Table: Vision, Mission, Values

Dimension	Official Wording	Citation
Vision	"A happy, healthy and creative child whose rights are protected and honoured..."	2
Mission Pillar 1	Taking Responsibility	2
Mission Pillar 2	Mobilising Potential	2
Mission Pillar 3	Inspiring Collective Action	2
Core Values	Dedication, Integrity, Accountability	43

Nav Srishti:

One of its earliest and longest-running partners in this belt is **Nav Srishti**, a community-based NGO located in South Delhi. Established in the early 1990s and receiving its first CRY grant in 1994, Nav Srishti works with marginalised and low-income communities, specifically the Banjaara basti and Gosai populations. Its work spans education, child protection, vocational training, and welfare service delivery.



Operational Model

CRY functions as a catalytic platform that channels public donations and institutional funding into structured partnerships with grassroots organisations. These partnerships are governed by rigorous monitoring, periodic evaluation, and data-backed outcome metrics. Partner NGOs are involved in programme co-design, and many implement community-based interventions focused on early childhood care, primary education, gender sensitisation, adolescent health, and vocational readiness.

At the field level, Nav Srishti embodies this model by providing direct services such as informal schooling, skill-building (e.g., stitching centres, beauty parlours), health referrals, and awareness sessions. It operates in coordination with CRY's strategic guidelines and aligns with its programmatic priorities.

Target Communities

Nav Srishti primarily serves children and families from the Banjaara basti and Gosai communities in the Nagloi–Saket belt. These groups face chronic exclusion from formal education, healthcare access, state entitlements, and civic infrastructure. The children attending Nav Srishti's centres often come from households engaged in informal labour, street vending, or domestic work, and many are first-generation learners.

The Social Problem / Project Worked On

2.1 The Broader Problem: Structural Inequality in Urban Education

The internship was situated within a systemic context of deep-rooted educational inequality in low-income urban communities. The children served by Nav Srishti, primarily from the Banjaara basti and Gosai communities, face chronic structural disadvantages: limited access to formal education, high rates of dropout, health vulnerabilities, poor living conditions, and exclusion from most state welfare schemes. Their educational journey is often interrupted or entirely bypassed due to the compounding effects of poverty, caste exclusion, unsafe environments, and domestic pressures such as early marriage or child labour.

In such contexts, NGOs like Nav Srishti attempt to fill the void left by the state through informal schooling, skill-building programs, and child protection services. However, these efforts are often hampered by severe institutional constraints, limited staff, inadequate infrastructure, poor resource availability, and unstable financial flows. The result is a fragile support system that survives more through individual dedication than structural soundness.

2.2 Ground-Level Manifestation: Key Institutional Gaps

During the course of the internship, the following structural deficits were repeatedly observed:

- **Acute Staffing Shortage:** One teacher (Uma Ma'am) was responsible for over 90 students on a daily basis, spanning both primary-level instruction (CAC) and secondary-level STEM subjects. There was no division of labour based on subject expertise or grade level, placing overwhelming academic and emotional burden on the sole educator.



- **Infrastructure Breakdown:** The centre had only one usable classroom (the STEM lab) which was cramped and had no ventilation; the computer lab was outdated, poorly ventilated, and could accommodate a maximum of seven students. There were no working microphones or speakers for public sessions. Rainwater leakage posed safety risks during monsoon. Drinking water was limited to a single RO system for the children.



STEM Lab with me teaching Biology :)

- **Health and Sanitation Gaps:** The site had no provision for regular doctor visits. Two unsupervised dogs roamed the premises, one aged and flea-infected on the ground floor near the kindergarten area, another urinating within teaching areas, posing hygiene and safety hazards. These concerns were raised multiple times without any concrete institutional response.



The entrance area, to Nav Srishti, which is a landfill for waste and cow feces.



The region near where the children live. (the children have developed a habit of swimming in such pools of water)

- **Academic Material Deficit:** There was no functioning library, and no access to printed textbooks. The only study materials available were worksheets, which the teacher was funding personally. Arts stream students dropped out due to complete exclusion from the curriculum.



The CAC (Child Activity Centre) student “library”, which contains books for 7th to 8th grade students, is currently rusty and broken.

- **Dropout Risk and Student Attrition:** The absence of curricular support, infrastructure, and psychosocial care led to visible disengagement among older students, especially those in non-STEM streams. The institutional environment was unable to sustain consistent learning pathways for these students.

2.3 Project Focus: Intern’s Assigned Role and Intervention Points

In response to the gaps outlined above, the internship focused on limited but strategic interventions aligned with three interrelated objectives:

1. **Instructional Support:** Assisting with daily H.E.M.S. classes (Hindi, English, Maths, Science) for students aged 7 to 12, and conducting biology lessons for senior students aged 12 to 18. These sessions aimed to supplement the overburdened teaching structure with content delivery, visual material, and comprehension-based reinforcement.
2. **Systems Strengthening:** Initiating documentation and process oriented tools to improve internal functioning. This included drafting an Intern Code of Conduct, planning a

structured intern handover system, and creating a centralised worksheet archive to ensure content continuity across intern cycles.

3. **Programmatic Development:** Designing and implementing co-curricular and strategic activities, such as the “Green Corner” (an environmental responsibility initiative) and a career counselling seminar for grades 10–12. These activities sought to provide non-academic engagement, reinforce discipline and ecological awareness, and offer long-term goal orientation to students on the verge of academic disengagement.



The children with their plants. :)

2.4 Framing the Core Problem

At its core, the problem addressed through this internship was not the absence of intent or effort, but the collapse of institutional capacity. With one teacher holding together an entire educational setup, without infrastructure, curricular depth, or administrative support, the system operated in survival mode. The focus of this project, therefore, was not to solve the problem in entirety, but to intervene meaningfully within its constraints. The work attempted to reduce

pressure on frontline educators, improve internal knowledge systems, and contribute toward student retention and motivation.

Activities / Tasks Carried Out During the Internship

The internship involved a blend of direct instructional responsibilities, institutional systems work, and programmatic interventions. The tasks were designed in response to visible gaps in capacity, structure, and delivery at the Nav Srishti centre, and were carried out in coordination with on-ground staff under the oversight of CRY's regional framework.

3.1 Classroom Teaching and Academic Support

3.1.1 H.E.M.S. Classes (Ages 7 to 12)

A core component of the internship involved conducting daily academic sessions under the H.E.M.S. framework, Hindi, English, Mathematics, and Science, targeting students in the 7 to 12 age group. Each subject was assigned a dedicated weekday, with sessions running from 10:00 AM to 12:00 PM.



One intern handles at least this many children at a time, (this image shows half a batch) while there were two interns.

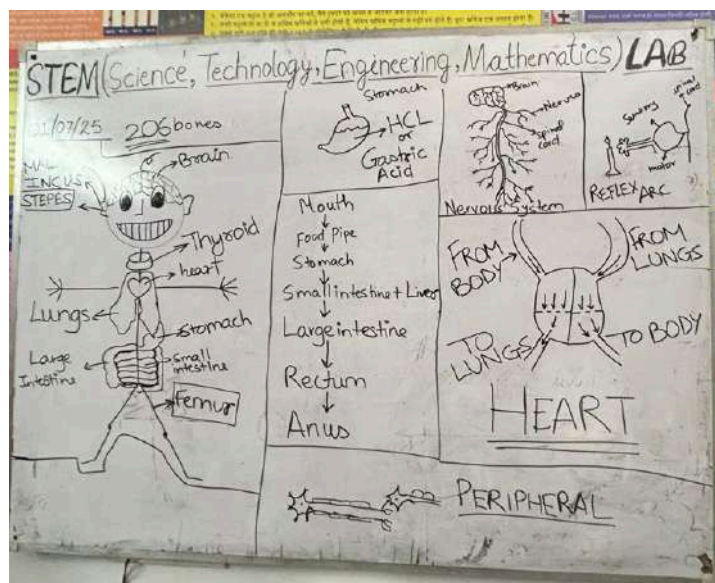
The teaching approach was adapted to students' varying literacy and comprehension levels, using simplified content delivery, oral questioning, and visual support. Worksheets were

developed and used to reinforce fundamental language and numeracy skills. Sessions were executed in collaboration with Uma Ma'am to ensure curricular alignment.

3.1.2 Senior Student Instruction (Ages 12 to 18)

For older students, topic-specific lessons in biology were conducted, covering basic concepts such as physiological systems, sensory organs, and human anatomy.

The sessions incorporated Canva-based presentations, hand-drawn visuals, and analogy-driven explanations to break down complex biological processes into accessible, real-world contexts. Recapitulation and retention checks were performed through oral Q&A and short written assessments.



My drawing skills aren't the best :(

3.1.3 Unit Test Preparation and Supervision

Additional instructional support was provided for unit tests, including:

- Hindi revision sessions for 5th and 7th grades
- Mathematics test supervision for 7th and 8th grades

The sessions focused on targeted reinforcement of weak areas identified through class interactions and prior assessments. Work was extended into Saturdays (overtime) to accommodate test schedules.

3.2 Program Design and Implementation

3.2.1 Green Corner Initiative

A co-curricular intervention titled “Green Corner” was conceptualised and launched during the internship. The initiative replaced weekly recreational sessions with structured environmental engagement.

Students were assigned potted plants and taught basic gardening techniques. The objective was to instill a sense of responsibility, routine, and environmental awareness through direct action. A revision session in science was later integrated into the initiative, using real-time observation of seed germination as a conceptual anchor for biology topics.



Me watering the plants at the Green Corner (the children forgot)

3.2.2 Career Counselling Seminar

In collaboration with two other interns, a structured seminar was organised for students in grades 10 to 12 and recent school graduates. The seminar covered:

- Career pathways and domain exposure
- Skill development requirements
- Goal-setting and decision-making frameworks

Students were guided through available post-secondary options, vocational alternatives, and public-sector resources. The session aimed to reduce informational gaps and provide direction for students with limited formal guidance.



Career Counselling Session with around 30 youths and parents

3.3 Institutional and Strategic Contributions

3.3.1 Intern Management Documentation

To address gaps in intern continuity and institutional memory, two structural documents were drafted:

- **Nav Srishti: Intern Code of Conduct & Child Safeguarding Guidelines:** A formal document outlining behavioural expectations, daily minimum contributions, and grievance redressal mechanisms for interns.
- **Intern Joining Agreement:** A document outlining the scope of work, minimum attendance, position expectations, hierarchies, etc.
- **Nav Srishti: Intern Code of Conduct: Professional Behaviour with Staff and Team Members:** Created after misbehaviour was documented and observed by other interns.

- **Intern Handover Framework:** A template for outgoing interns to submit a structured report covering lesson plans, observations, and pending tasks, intended to reduce duplication of effort across cycles.

A centralised worksheet archive was also initiated, requiring interns to submit 1 worksheet per working day (or 3 per week). This was designed to ensure a growing bank of age-appropriate academic materials for sustained classroom use as a part of the codes of conduct for the interns.

3.3.2 CRY Headquarters Visit and Reporting Alignment

A visit to the CRY Delhi office was conducted to obtain clarity on reporting protocols and documentation standards. Organisational material, including project guidelines, evaluation rubrics, and publication references, was collected to align Nav Srishti's internal reports with CRY's broader framework. (*Mentioned in Appendix A*)

3.3.3 Branch Coordination and Data Consolidation

To improve organisational coherence across different Nav Srishti branches, a cross-connection Excel report was created and updated. This sheet mapped activity status, resource availability, and programmatic gaps for each branch, offering a centralised view for the core team. The effort aimed at streamlining oversight and facilitating data-driven decision-making.

3.4 Research and Syllabus Structuring

3.4.1 Secondary Data Analysis and Report Drafting

Under the guidance of the NGO's reporting coordinator, thematic research was conducted using data from NFHS-3, 4, and 5. Reports were drafted on the following domains:

- Malnutrition in children
- Girls' education access (up to high school)
- Maternal, antenatal, and postnatal care
- Disease prevalence (HIV/AIDS, RTI/STI)
- Haemoglobin levels in women (15–49)
- Infant mortality and institutional vs. home births
- Women's empowerment and reproductive rights access

Comparative trend tables were developed to track progress and stagnation across these domains. Drafts were intended for internal program evaluation and grant reporting.

3.4.2 Teaching Syllabus Framework

Preliminary work began on a subject-wise weekly content framework to help future interns maintain pedagogical continuity. The framework proposed modular lesson plans per subject and grade cluster, aligned with common topics, local learning levels, and logistical constraints.

3.4.3 Collection and compilation of case studies

Compilation of 3 decades worth of case studies into one document along with a division of yearly annual reports, for the purpose of submission to a future investor.

3.3.4 Safeguarding Meeting and Case Discussions

A focused safeguarding meeting was convened to address the cases of three individual children who had reported serious concerns:

- Child A: Subjected to abuse within the school premises and isolation from peers.
- Child B: Alleged physical misconduct threats by a private tuition teacher.
- Child C: Displayed self-harm indicators and acute psychological distress.

The meeting brought together staff members, field workers, and regular follow-up schedules were also established to monitor each child's wellbeing and academic continuity.

3.3.5 College Application Support and Fraud Awareness

A staff member reported irregularities in her son's college application process. Investigation revealed a local internet café charging parents between ₹600 and ₹6,000, far above standard service rates, for form-filling assistance.

Actions taken:

- Conducted a detailed review of typical application costs and documented the exploitative fee scale.
- Compiled an advisory brief for staff and parents, outlining legitimate channels for form submission and warning against unregulated agents.
- Submitted a report to Nav Srishti leadership recommending engagement with consumer-protection authorities to address the malpractice.

This case is what sparked the career counselling session scheduling, which ended up being a success.

Findings and Suggestions

4.1 Findings

1. Single teacher responsible for 90+ students across primary and secondary levels.
2. No subject-specific division; no relief or succession plan.
3. One usable classroom; computer lab seats seven; no ventilation or air conditioning.
4. No PA system; roof leaks during monsoon.
5. Single RO unit for drinking water; no scanner or printer.
6. No regular medical check-ups; unsupervised, disease-carrying animals on premises.
7. Absence of library, printed textbooks, and formal study materials.
8. Arts stream excluded from curriculum; worksheets not produced by NGO.
9. Older and Arts-stream students disengaged and dropped out.

10. No formal intern handover; no code of conduct.
11. Branch activities uncoordinated; data silos.

4.2 Suggestions

1. Recruit three additional teachers (primary languages/maths, Arts, Secondary STEM).
2. Define subject-specialist roles; distribute workload.
3. Acquire or renovate a second classroom; expand computer lab capacity; install ventilation.
4. Install PA equipment; repair roof.
5. Add a second RO unit; secure scanner and printer.
6. Organise bi-monthly medical camps; implement animal-control measures; schedule sanitisation.
7. Establish mini-library; digitise key resources; standardise worksheet repository.
8. Develop and integrate Arts curriculum module.
9. Institutionalise quarterly career-counselling sessions; partner with local institutions.
10. Finalise and enforce Intern Code of Conduct and handover framework.
11. Maintain a cross-branch dashboard with monthly updates.

Learnings

5.1 Pedagogical Insights

- Adapting lesson plans to literacy levels accelerates comprehension.
- Visual aids and analogies demystify complex concepts.
- Real-time, hands-on activities (e.g., seed germination) reinforce retention more effectively than lectures alone.

5.2 Institutional Problem-Solving

- Structured documentation (code of conduct, handover framework) prevents knowledge loss across intern cycles.
- Centralised data consolidation reveals branch-level gaps and informs resource allocation.
- Rapid case review protocols enable timely safeguarding interventions.

5.3 Personal Development

- Classroom management under resource constraints strengthened organisational discipline.
- Designing and executing programmes honed project-planning and execution skills.
- Exposure to crisis scenarios (abuse cases, health hazards) developed emotional resilience and professional detachment.

5.4 Exposure to Structural Realities

- Single-teacher model and infrastructural decay illustrate systemic neglect of urban informal education.
- Absence of basic facilities underscores the gap between policy rhetoric and field implementation.
- Persistent resource shortages confirm that NGO impact relies on individual dedication rather than institutional robustness.

Limitations of Study, Conclusion & Recommendations

6.1 Limitations of Study

1. Time constraint: Four-week period is insufficient for sustained programme evaluation or systemic change.
2. Limited authority: Intern status restricted decision-making; recommendations lacked executive force.
3. No funding control: Reliance on existing budgets prevented materialising infrastructure or staffing proposals.
4. Redtaping: Getting to meet and discuss with higher-level management proved to be difficult due to their busy schedules.

The internship exposed chronic institutional deficits, staffing overload, infrastructural decay, resource shortages, that undermine educational delivery in marginalised urban communities. Interventions provided tactical support but did not alter foundational capacity. Impact was confined to incremental improvements in teaching quality, process documentation, and short-term student engagement.

6.2 Recommendations

1. Extend internship duration to at least eight weeks to enable follow-through on process reforms and programme pilots.
2. Delegate decision-making authority to senior interns for minor budget allocations and procurement within predefined limits.
3. Secure dedicated micro-grants for infrastructure upgrades and teaching materials, controlled by the regional office with transparent disbursement.
4. Institutionalise quarterly reviews of programme metrics and branch-level audits to monitor implementation of recommendations.
5. Establish a permanent liaison role between CRY Delhi and Nav Srishti to ensure continuity of strategic oversight and follow-up.

Conclusion:

The internship exposed chronic institutional failures, severe understaffing, dilapidated infrastructure, and resource scarcity, that erode educational delivery in marginalised urban communities. Tactical interventions offered marginal relief: reinforced classroom instruction, documented processes, and focused programmes. These measures did not resolve foundational capacity gaps. The experience delivered unfiltered insight into the resilience of frontline educators and the fragility of systems held together by individual dedication.

A month for me, a lifetime for them.

Appendix A:

Interview with Mrs. Savita, CRY Delhi

Q: What are the primary modes through which CRY receives investments?

Mrs. Savita: CRY works through three major investment models: Direct Intervention (DI), Partner-Based, and Fellow-Based. DI funding comes directly from donors and is used in areas where the CRY team identifies problems firsthand. Partner-based models rely on experienced NGOs, selected through field and financial audits. Fellow-based interventions work on systemic issues like child labour and government policy, with accountability maintained through regular checks.

Q: How is fund allocation managed across the year?

Mrs. Savita: Funds are distributed quarterly. The quarterly cycle depends on internal operations; some follow the April to March fiscal cycle, others run from December–January. Activities are divided accordingly. Annual reviews then determine whether priorities shift or continue.

Q: Who are some of the key donors CRY works with?

Mrs. Savita: Major donors include UNICEF, Google, Microsoft, Blackrock, Hero Group, Lotte Group, and FIA Global Fund. We also receive contributions from individual Indian citizens.

Q: How does CRY function operationally in Delhi?

Mrs. Savita: CRY operates in 8 districts in Delhi. Each community includes about 2,000 households. We use a proprietary app called Pragati to audit households, record details, and observe longitudinal trends. Child labour has reduced as a result of our interventions, and specific metrics are maintained for internal tracking.

Q: What was the rationale behind the intern postings?

Mrs. Savita: Intern locations are assigned based on preferences and safety considerations. For example, areas like Sakhsham, where eve teasing is reported, are generally avoided. Intern feedback is also collected from local partners to ensure effectiveness.

Q: How is intern performance and project effectiveness monitored?

Mrs. Savita: Reviews happen quarterly and annually. Data, analysis, and outcomes are presented to senior management in PPT form. Intern monitoring is partly handled by the VE team and reinforced through partner feedback.

Q: How does CRY manage community development beyond funding?

Mrs. Savita: Through participatory resource planning. We involve stakeholders like children, parents, teachers, and government bodies to co-develop solutions. This includes building child collectives, conducting research with children, and creating local ecosystems that support child rights.

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